GRAPPLING (5E, 2024 RULES) – DESCRIPTION

Grappling means seizing a creature to hold it down. In 2024, grappling is an option of the **Unarmed Strike**: the target makes a **saving throw** against a fixed DC, instead of an opposed check.

🎲 Quick summary:

1. With the **Attack** action, make an Unarmed Strike and choose **Grapple**.
2. You need a **free hand**, a target within reach, and at most **one size larger** than you.
3. The target succeeds on a **Strength** or **Dexterity** save (its choice) against **DC 8 + Str modifier + Proficiency Bonus**.
4. On a failure, it is **Grappled**.
5. To escape, it uses its action: an **Athletics** or **Acrobatics** check against the same DC.

⚠ The Grappled condition:

- Its **Speed is 0**.
- It has **Disadvantage** on attack rolls against any target other than the grappler.
- The condition ends if the grappler is **Incapacitated**, or if an effect moves the target out of reach (e.g. *Thunderwave*).

⚠ Change from 2014

Grappling is no longer a special attack with an opposed Athletics check: it is a **saving throw against a fixed DC**, and escaping uses the same DC. The Grappled condition also imposes Disadvantage on attacks against anyone but the grappler. You also need a free hand per grappled creature.

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

A prone, grappled target can't stand up (Speed 0), and its enemies get Advantage. This combination is very strong. Fix: the **DM may give large creatures easier escapes**.

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

The DM can describe the hold (a locked arm, a grip around the neck) and the target twisting to break free.

Step 1 – Get ready to grapple:

You have a **free hand**. The target is within your reach and at most one size larger than you.

Step 2 – Make an Unarmed Strike:

With the **Attack** action, use an Unarmed Strike and choose **Grapple** instead of dealing damage. It replaces one of your attacks.

Step 3 – The target defends:

It makes a **Strength** or **Dexterity** save (its choice) against **DC 8 + your Str modifier + your Proficiency Bonus**. If it fails, it is Grappled.

Example: Brann (Str +4, Proficiency +2) has a DC of 14. The goblin chooses Dexterity (+2), rolls 10: 10 + 2 = 12, below 14, it is grappled.

Step 4 – Move the target:

When you move, you can drag or carry the grappled creature. Each foot of movement costs 1 extra foot (Speed halved), unless the target is Tiny or at least two sizes smaller than you.

Step 5 – Escape or release:

- The grappled creature uses its action: a **Strength (Athletics)** or **Dexterity (Acrobatics)** check against the grapple DC. Success ends the condition.
- The condition ends if the grappler becomes Incapacitated or the target is moved out of reach.
- You can release the target whenever you wish.

Common table questions.

Can I grapple a larger creature?

Only if it is at most one size larger than you.

How many creatures can I grapple?

One per free hand: you need a free hand for each grapple.

What about an Incapacitated target?

The 2024 text has no automatic success: the target makes its save. But a Paralyzed, Stunned, or Unconscious creature automatically fails Strength and Dexterity saves.

Can a grappled creature attack?

Yes, but with Disadvantage against any target other than the grappler. It can also cast spells.

Can it move or stand up?

Its Speed is 0: it can't move and, if prone, can't stand up.

What bonus for a Monk?

Thanks to Martial Arts, the Monk can use Dexterity for Unarmed Strikes, including the grapple DC.

Does releasing the target take an action?

No: you release whenever you want, with no action.

What if the target is hurled away?

The condition ends if an effect moves it out of the grapple's reach (e.g. *Thunderwave*).

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

Grappled and attacks

A Grappled creature can still attack: the condition only limits its movement.

Opportunity Attack

An Opportunity Attack can be a Grapple or a Shove, via the Unarmed Strike options.

Grappler knocked Prone

If the grappler falls Prone, it keeps its hold: the target isn't Prone as well.

Help without staying adjacent

The Help action doesn't require you to stay next to the foe: you can help then move away.

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